

►► PRESSING

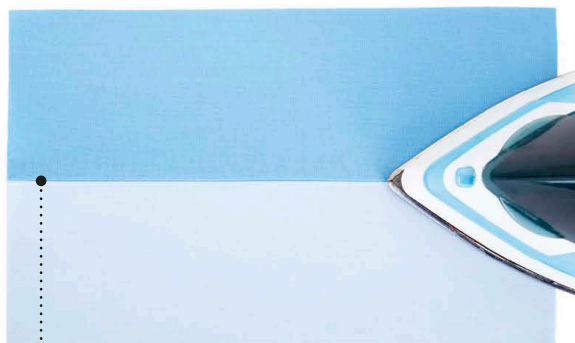
Pressing is essential when making accurate patchwork. It is different to ironing, which can cause fabric and seams to distort. When pressing, press down in one place, then lift the iron and move it before pressing down on another area. Set pieces aside to cool after

each pressing and always press the seam towards the darker fabric to prevent darker colours from showing through lighter fabrics. The temperature of the iron should be appropriate to the fabric.

PRESSING STRAIGHT SEAMS



1 Place the unit or sewn strips with right sides together on the ironing board with the darker fabric on top. Press the iron along the seam, lifting the iron at regular intervals. This is called “setting the seam”. It helps ensure accuracy by locking the threads in place and smoothing the fibres of the fabric.



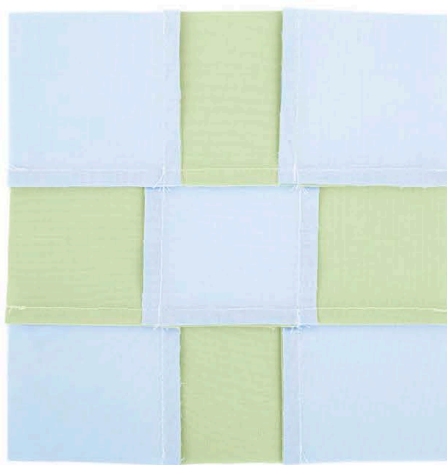
2 Open the unit to the right side and press from one end to the other along the seam. If you keep the lighter piece nearest you and press with the tip of the iron, you can press the seam to the darker side at the same time as you open the unit.

PRESSING BIAS SEAMS



Work along the straight grain to prevent the seam from being pulled out of shape. Lift the iron and replace it rather than dragging it along the seam.

WORKING IN ROWS



Press the seams in adjoining rows in opposite directions from one another to minimize bulkiness where the seams join.